# SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

**12 April 2021 · Shift 1**

66 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 34 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

## English Language 25 questions

**Q.1**

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options, pick the one that gives their correct order. A. There he brought them up as his own children. B. He took them away to his hut. C. He found the two children and the basket. D. One day an old man came to the jungle.

**(A)** BACD
**(B)** DCBA
**(C)** BDAC
**(D)** DBAC

**Q.2**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. The eradication of corona virus is still “a far cry”.

**(A)** very near
**(B)** very easy
**(C)** very fast
**(D)** very distant

**Q.3**

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

**(A)** instead
**(B)** install
**(C)** instanse
**(D)** inspire

**Q.4**

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution’. The house “has been auction” before we reached there.

**(A)** No substitution
**(B)** was auctioning
**(C)** had been auctioned
**(D)** has been auctioned

**Q.5**

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. RESOLVE

**(A)** analyse
**(B)** refuse
**(C)** decide
**(D)** agree

**Q.6**

Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word. PRECIOUS

**(A)** costly
**(B)** simple
**(C)** rare
**(D)** cheap

**Q.7**

Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words. speed greater than that of sound

**(A)** harmonic
**(B)** cacophonic
**(C)** supersonic
**(D)** subsonic

**Q.8**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. PRUDENT

**(A)** reckless
**(B)** rude
**(C)** hasty
**(D)** cautious

**Q.9**

Select the option which means the same as the group of words given. A place where Buddhist monks live

**(A)** monastery
**(B)** pagoda
**(C)** stupa
**(D)** temple

**Q.10**

Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Select the option that gives their correct order. A. This flight takes place on a hot summer day. B. It has a pair of wings but bites them off after its 'wedding' flight. C. In the heat, the queen leaves the nest and goes out to meet a drone, high up in the air. D. The queen is the mother of the entire population of a colony of ants.

**(A)** CABD
**(B)** BACD
**(C)** DBAC
**(D)** ACBD

**Q.11**

Fill in the blank with most appropriate word. _____ of adulterated food stuff being sold in the market.

**(A)** Wary
**(B)** Beware
**(C)** Aware
**(D)** Cautious

**Q.12**

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. The prisoners of this jail have woven these carpets.

**(A)** The prisoners have been woven by these carpets of this jail.
**(B)** These carpets have been woven by the prisoners of this jail.
**(C)** These carpets were woven by the prisoners of this jail.
**(D)** These carpets wove the prisoners of this jail.

**Q.13**

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. The gardener said to the children, "Please do not pluck any flowers."

**(A)** The gardener requested the children not to pluck any flowers.
**(B)** The gardener told to the children to kindly not pluck any flowers.
**(C)** The gardener ordered the children to not pluck any flowers.
**(D)** The gardener requested to the children please do not pluck any flowers.

**Q.14**

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. Why didn't you submitted your project on time?

**(A)** you submitted
**(B)** your project
**(C)** Why didn't
**(D)** on time

**Q.15**

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. Electric heaters were providing to all the officers at the guest house.

**(A)** at the guest house
**(B)** were providing
**(C)** to all the officers
**(D)** Electric heaters

**Q.16**

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. STRETCH

**(A)** extend
**(B)** cease
**(C)** close
**(D)** compress

**Q.17**

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Living in a fool's paradise

**(A)** To believe wrongly that your situation is good
**(B)** To be fooled by someone
**(C)** To live in luxuriously after fooling someone
**(D)** To live in a world of imagination

**Q.18**

Select the misspelt word.

**(A)** parachute
**(B)** partner
**(C)** tarriff
**(D)** sergeant

**Q.19**

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'. Supriya as well as her friends "have gone of" a trekking expedition.

**(A)** have gone on
**(B)** has gone on
**(C)** No substitution
**(D)** are going at

**Q.20**

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I should have stopped them then and there. But it never even _____ to me that I should.

**(A)** suggested
**(B)** happened
**(C)** occurred
**(D)** reminded

**Q.21**

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Before the giant waves slammed into the coast in India and Sri Lanka, wild and domestic animals (1) _____ to know what was about to happen. (2) _____ fled to safety. According to eyewitness (3) _____, elephants screamed and ran for (4) _____ grounds, dogs refused to go outdoors, flamingoes abandoned (5) _____ low-lying breeding areas and zoo animals rushed into their shelters.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 1.

**(A)** were seemed
**(B)** seeming
**(C)** seem
**(D)** seemed

**Q.22**

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Before the giant waves slammed into the coast in India and Sri Lanka, wild and domestic animals (1) _____ to know what was about to happen. (2) _____ fled to safety. According to eyewitness (3) _____, elephants screamed and ran for (4) _____ grounds, dogs refused to go outdoors, flamingoes abandoned (5) _____ low-lying breeding areas and zoo animals rushed into their shelters.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 2.

**(A)** They
**(B)** Them
**(C)** Us
**(D)** We

**Q.23**

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Before the giant waves slammed into the coast in India and Sri Lanka, wild and domestic animals (1) _____ to know what was about to happen. (2) _____ fled to safety. According to eyewitness (3) _____, elephants screamed and ran for (4) _____ grounds, dogs refused to go outdoors, flamingoes abandoned (5) _____ low-lying breeding areas and zoo animals rushed into their shelters.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 3.

**(A)** statement
**(B)** accounts
**(C)** narrations
**(D)** explanations

**Q.24**

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Before the giant waves slammed into the coast in India and Sri Lanka, wild and domestic animals (1) _____ to know what was about to happen. (2) _____ fled to safety. According to eyewitness (3) _____, elephants screamed and ran for (4) _____ grounds, dogs refused to go outdoors, flamingoes abandoned (5) _____ low-lying breeding areas and zoo animals rushed into their shelters.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 4.

**(A)** highest
**(B)** high
**(C)** more high
**(D)** higher

**Q.25**

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Before the giant waves slammed into the coast in India and Sri Lanka, wild and domestic animals (1) _____ to know what was about to happen. (2) _____ fled to safety. According to eyewitness (3) _____, elephants screamed and ran for (4) _____ grounds, dogs refused to go outdoors, flamingoes abandoned (5) _____ low-lying breeding areas and zoo animals rushed into their shelters.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 5.

**(A)** our
**(B)** theirs
**(C)** their
**(D)** her

## General Intelligence 17 questions

**Q.1**

P and Q are husband and wife. P's father-in-law is R's wife's father. Q is the brother of T. How is P related to R's wife?

**(A)** Aunt
**(B)** Cousin
**(C)** Sister-in-law
**(D)** Brother

**Q.4**

Select the word-pair in which the two words are related in the same way as are the two words in the following word-pair. Spoon : Utensil

**(A)** Scooter : Vehicle
**(B)** Bus : Passenger
**(C)** House : Expenditure
**(D)** Kitchen : Cooking

**Q.5**

Vijay is 8 years younger than Amit. The sum of the current ages of Vijay and Amit is 42 years. What is the current age of Vijay?

**(A)** 17 years
**(B)** 25 years
**(C)** 21 years
**(D)** 15 years

**Q.8**

Select the option that is related to the third number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number. 25 : 750 : : 30 : ?

**(A)** 1110
**(B)** 1275
**(C)** 1625
**(D)** 1050

**Q.10**

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given letter series will complete the series. a _ _ gb _ _ acegb _ _ aceg _ _ _

**(A)** dfdfbcedf
**(B)** cedfdfbdf
**(C)** fdfbdfced
**(D)** cefbdfdfd

**Q.11**

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 2, 4, 5, 19, 71, ?

**(A)** 361
**(B)** 316
**(C)** 216
**(D)** 261

**Q.12**

Four number-pairs have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the one that is different.

**(A)** 5 : 65
**(B)** 8 : 104
**(C)** 12 : 146
**(D)** 11 : 143

**Q.14**

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1. Rubric 2. Ruminate 3. Rose 4. Reader 5. Reap

**(A)** 4, 5, 3, 1, 2
**(B)** 4, 3, 5, 1, 2
**(C)** 4, 5, 3, 2, 1
**(D)** 4, 5, 1, 3, 2

**Q.15**

Select the option in which the numbers share the same relationship as that shared by the numbers of the given set. (8, 44, 224)

**(A)** (11, 59, 299)
**(B)** (9, 80, 312)
**(C)** (15, 75, 301)
**(D)** (7, 39, 190)

**Q.16**

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term. SLIM : MHQO : : COLD : ?

**(A)** GPZK
**(B)** GKPZ
**(C)** GPKZ
**(D)** GZPK

**Q.18**

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (57, 126, 199)

**(A)** (75, 148, 217)
**(B)** (29, 96, 168)
**(C)** (63, 132, 205)
**(D)** (43, 112, 178)

**Q.19**

In a code language, if SEND is written as 168, then how will PURSE be written in the same language?

**(A)** 185
**(B)** 225
**(C)** 395
**(D)** 415

**Q.21**

In a certain code language, BEYOND is written as BDFNPY. How will PROMISE be written in that language?

**(A)** FJNPQSR
**(B)** ESIMORP
**(C)** EIMOPRS
**(D)** FJMPPRS

**Q.22**

Three of the following four letter-clusters are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the odd one.

**(A)** LPT
**(B)** GKO
**(C)** QUY
**(D)** HLQ

**Q.23**

Four words have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the word that is different.

**(A)** Equivocal
**(B)** Hesitant
**(C)** Ambivalent
**(D)** Certain

**Q.24**

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. Ohmmeter : Resistance : : Zymometer : ?

**(A)** Viscosity
**(B)** Density
**(C)** Fermentation
**(D)** Radiation

**Q.25**

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs that can sequentially replace the * signs and balance the given equation. 14 * 11 * 552 * 23 * 29 = 159

**(A)** ×, +, ÷, −
**(B)** ×, −, ÷, +
**(C)** ×, ÷, −, +
**(D)** +, −, ÷, ×

## General Awareness 24 questions

**Q.1**

Who among the following has been appointed as the Deputy Election Commissioner in the Election Commission of India?

**(A)** Rajan Datta
**(B)** Ashok Lavasa
**(C)** Umesh Sinha
**(D)** Rajiv Kumar

**Q.2**

Swami Vivekananda established Ramakrishna Mission in the year _____.

**(A)** 1876
**(B)** 1897
**(C)** 1899
**(D)** 1882

**Q.3**
Which of the following is an extension of a temporary file?

**(A)** .tnt
**(B)** .tar
**(C)** .tmp
**(D)** .txt

**Q.4**
Birdie, eagle and albatross are all terms used in _____.

**(A)** golf
**(B)** polo
**(C)** baseball
**(D)** football

**Q.5**
_____ holds the Indian record for the most test matches as captain as of December 2020.

**(A)** Mohammad Azharuddin
**(B)** Kapil Dev
**(C)** MS Dhoni
**(D)** Virat Kohli

**Q.6**
Which of the following planets has the most number of moons?

**(A)** Jupiter
**(B)** Saturn
**(C)** Uranus
**(D)** Neptune

**Q.7**
Which of the following festivals of Tamil Nadu is dedicated to Lord Muruga?

**(A)** Onam
**(B)** Pongal
**(C)** Thai Poosam
**(D)** Aadi Perukku

**Q.8**
In 2020, India co-sponsored a security council resolution that calls for full, effective and meaningful participation of _____ personnel in peacekeeping operations.

**(A)** police
**(B)** medical
**(C)** nursing
**(D)** women

**Q.9**
Champaran Satyagraha was launched in which of the following years?

**(A)** 1935
**(B)** 1917
**(C)** 1928
**(D)** 1945

**Q.10**
In how many countries, Union Cabinet approved the opening of Indian Missions in 2021?

**(A)** 3
**(B)** 6
**(C)** 9
**(D)** 5

**Q.11**
AMR occurs when bacteria, viruses, fungi and parasites change over time and no longer respond to medicines making infections harder to treat and increasing the risk of disease spread, severe illness and death. What is the full form of AMR?

**(A)** Acutemicrobial Resistance
**(B)** Antimalarial Resistance
**(C)** Antimeasles Resistance
**(D)** Antimicrobial Resistance

**Q.13**
What kind of soil is most suitable for growing cashew nuts?

**(A)** Red and yellow soil
**(B)** Alluvia soil
**(C)** Black soil
**(D)** Red laterite soil

**Q.14**
Who among the following is the first female Chief Justice of Telangana?

**(A)** Hima Kohli
**(B)** JK Maheshwari
**(C)** Ruma Pal
**(D)** R Banumathi

**Q.15**
Hakki, Pikki and Siddi are _____ from Karnataka.

**(A)** languages
**(B)** theatre forms
**(C)** music types
**(D)** dance forms

**Q.16**
Who is the author of the book 'Pathway to God'?

**(A)** Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
**(B)** Mahatma Gandhi
**(C)** Sri Aurobindo
**(D)** Jawaharlal Nehru

**Q.17**
Which helpline was launched by the Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment in September 2020?

**(A)** ASHA
**(B)** SUBAH
**(C)** KIRAN
**(D)** UMMID

**Q.18**
Which of the following banks has launched contactless ‘RuPay Select’ debit card in association with NPCI (National Payment Corporation of India) in December 2020?

**(A)** Central Bank of India
**(B)** ICICI
**(C)** HDFC
**(D)** SBI

**Q.19**
Which of the following lakes of Maharashtra has been included in the list of Ramsar Sites in November 2020?

**(A)** Vihar
**(B)** Rankala
**(C)** Lonar
**(D)** Venna

**Q.20**
Which of the following is the most literate district in India as per Census 2011?

**(A)** Ernakulam
**(B)** Kottayam
**(C)** Serchhip
**(D)** Champhai

**Q.21**
Who has authored the book titled ‘India’s 71-Year Test: The Journey to Triumph in Australia’?

**(A)** R Kaushik
**(B)** Rahul Bhattacharya
**(C)** Peter Hayter
**(D)** Sachin Tendulkar

**Q.22**
As per The Indian Tourism Statistics (ITS) 2020, which Indian state attracted the highest number of domestic tourists in the country in 2019?

**(A)** Uttar Pradesh
**(B)** Tamil Nadu
**(C)** Goa
**(D)** Meghalaya

**Q.23**
As of January 2021, who among the following is the Union Minister of Rural Development?

**(A)** Rajnath Singh
**(B)** Amit Shah
**(C)** Narendra Singh Tomar
**(D)** S Jaishankar

**Q.24**

_____ is generally called as milk sugar as it is found in milk.

**(A)** Glucose
**(B)** Fructose
**(C)** Maltose
**(D)** Lactose

**Q.25**

Which of the following cities is situated on the banks of river Saryu?

**(A)** Ahmedabad
**(B)** Jaipur
**(C)** Hyderabad
**(D)** Ayodhya

# Answer key

### English Language

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(B)** | Q.2 **(D)** | Q.3 **(C)** | Q.4 **(C)** | Q.5 **(B)** | Q.6 **(D)** |
| Q.7 **(C)** | Q.8 **(D)** | Q.9 **(A)** | Q.10 **(C)** | Q.11 **(B)** | Q.12 **(B)** |
| Q.13 **(A)** | Q.14 **(A)** | Q.15 **(B)** | Q.16 **(A)** | Q.17 **(A)** | Q.18 **(C)** |
| Q.19 **(B)** | Q.20 **(C)** | Q.21 **(D)** | Q.22 **(A)** | Q.23 **(B)** | Q.24 **(D)** |
| Q.25 **(C)** | | | | | |

### General Intelligence

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(C)** | Q.4 **(A)** | Q.5 **(A)** | Q.8 **(D)** | Q.10 **(B)** | Q.11 **(A)** |
| Q.12 **(C)** | Q.14 **(A)** | Q.15 **(A)** | Q.16 **(D)** | Q.18 **(C)** | Q.19 **(C)** |
| Q.21 **(D)** | Q.22 **(D)** | Q.23 **(D)** | Q.24 **(C)** | Q.25 **(B)** | |

### General Awareness

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Q.1 **(C)** | Q.2 **(B)** | Q.3 **(C)** | Q.4 **(A)** | Q.5 **(C)** | Q.6 **(B)** |
| Q.7 **(C)** | Q.8 **(D)** | Q.9 **(B)** | Q.10 **(A)** | Q.11 **(D)** | Q.13 **(D)** |
| Q.14 **(A)** | Q.15 **(A)** | Q.16 **(B)** | Q.17 **(C)** | Q.18 **(A)** | Q.19 **(C)** |
| Q.20 **(C)** | Q.21 **(A)** | Q.22 **(A)** | Q.23 **(C)** | Q.24 **(D)** | Q.25 **(D)** |

## Explanations

### English Language

**Q.1 · Answer (B) DCBA**

D brings in the old man, C has him find the children, B has him take them to his hut and A says he raised them there: DCBA.

**Q.2 · Answer (D) very distant**

'A far cry' means a long way off: the eradication is still very distant.

**Q.3 · Answer (C) instanse**

The correct spelling is 'instance'.

**Q.4 · Answer (C) had been auctioned**

The auction came before another past action, 'we reached', so the past perfect passive: 'had been auctioned'.

**Q.5 · Answer (B) refuse**

To 'resolve' is to decide firmly to do something; its opposite here is 'refuse', to decline to do it. 'Decide' is a synonym.

**Q.6 · Answer (D) cheap**

'Precious' means of great value; its opposite is 'cheap'. 'Costly' and 'rare' are close to synonyms.

**Q.7 · Answer (C) supersonic**

'Supersonic' means faster than sound; 'subsonic' means slower than sound.

**Q.8 · Answer (D) cautious**

'Prudent' means acting with care and good judgement: 'cautious'.

**Q.9 · Answer (A) monastery**

A monastery is a place where monks live together; stupas, pagodas and temples are monuments or places of worship.

**Q.10 · Answer (C) DBAC**

D introduces the queen, B mentions her wings and her 'wedding' flight, A says when this flight takes place and C describes it: DBAC.

**Q.11 · Answer (B) Beware**

'Beware of' is a warning on its own; 'wary', 'aware' and 'cautious' are adjectives and would need 'Be' before them.

**Q.12 · Answer (B) These carpets have been woven by the prisoners of this jail.**

The present perfect active 'have woven' becomes the present perfect passive 'have been woven', with the carpets as subject.

**Q.13 · Answer (A) The gardener requested the children not to pluck any flowers.**

A polite request with 'please' is reported with 'requested' and the infinitive: 'requested the children not to pluck any flowers'.

**Q.14 · Answer (A) you submitted**

After 'did' (here 'didn't') the verb takes its base form: 'Why didn't you submit your project on time?'

**Q.15 · Answer (B) were providing**

The heaters were given to the officers, so the verb must be passive: 'Electric heaters were provided to all the officers'.

**Q.16 · Answer (A) extend**

To 'stretch' something is to 'extend' it; 'compress' is the opposite.

**Q.17 · Answer (A) To believe wrongly that your situation is good**
To live in a fool's paradise is to be content because you wrongly believe your situation is good.

**Q.18 · Answer (C) tarriff**
The correct spelling is 'tariff'.

**Q.19 · Answer (B) has gone on**
With 'as well as' the verb agrees with the first subject, 'Supriya', so it is singular; and one goes 'on' an expedition: 'has gone on'.

**Q.20 · Answer (C) occurred**
An idea 'occurs to' someone: 'it never even occurred to me that I should'.

**Q.21 · Answer (D) seemed**
The animals 'seemed' to know: the simple past, like the rest of the passage.

**Q.22 · Answer (A) They**
'They', the subject of 'fled', refers back to the animals.

**Q.23 · Answer (B) accounts**
'Eyewitness accounts' are the reports of people who saw what happened.

**Q.24 · Answer (D) higher**
The elephants ran for 'higher' grounds, away from the low coast the waves struck.

**Q.25 · Answer (C) their**
The breeding areas were the flamingoes' own, so the plural possessive 'their'.

### General Intelligence

**Q.1 · Answer (C) Sister-in-law**
Q is T's brother, so Q is the husband and P the wife. P's father-in-law, Q's father, is also the father of R's wife, so R's wife is Q's sister, and P, her brother's wife, is her sister-in-law.

**Q.4 · Answer (A) Scooter : Vehicle**
A spoon is a kind of utensil, as a scooter is a kind of vehicle.

**Q.5 · Answer (A) 17 years**
Vijay + (Vijay + 8) = 42, so 2 × Vijay = 34 and Vijay is 17 years old.

**Q.8 · Answer (D) 1050**
The second number is the first times 5 more than itself: 25 × 30 = 750. Likewise 30 × 35 = 1050.

**Q.10 · Answer (B) cedfdfbdf**
With c, e, d, f, d, f, b, d, f in the blanks the block acegbdf repeats: acegbdf acegbdf acegbdf.

**Q.11 · Answer (A) 361**
Multiply by 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 in turn and add 2, –3, 4, –5, 6 in turn: 2 × 1 + 2 = 4, 4 × 2 – 3 = 5, 5 × 3 + 4 = 19 and 19 × 4 – 5 = 71, so next comes 71 × 5 + 6 = 361.

**Q.12 · Answer (C) 12 : 146**
In 5 : 65, 8 : 104 and 11 : 143 the second number is 13 times the first. 12 × 13 = 156, not 146, so 12 : 146 is the odd one.

**Q.14 · Answer (A) 4, 5, 3, 1, 2**
In dictionary order: Reader (4), Reap (5), Rose (3), Rubric (1), Ruminate (2). 'Read' comes before 'Reap', and 'Rub' before 'Rum'.

**Q.15 · Answer (A) (11, 59, 299)**
Each number is 5 times the one before it plus 4: 8 × 5 + 4 = 44 and 44 × 5 + 4 = 224. Likewise 11 × 5 + 4 = 59 and 59 × 5 + 4 = 299.

**Q.16 · Answer (D) GZPK**
The letters are put in alphabetical order and then moved +4, −4, +4, −4: SLIM → I L M S → M H Q O. So COLD → C D L O → G Z P K (D moved back 4 wraps round to Z).

**Q.18 · Answer (C) (63, 132, 205)**
In each set the second number is 69 more than the first and the third 73 more than the second: 57 → 126 → 199. Likewise 63 → 132 → 205.

**Q.19 · Answer (C) 395**
Each code is the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet times the number of letters: SEND = (19 + 5 + 14 + 4) × 4 = 168. So PURSE = (16 + 21 + 18 + 19 + 5) × 5 = 79 × 5 = 395.

**Q.21 · Answer (D) FJMPPRS**
The letters are put in alphabetical order and each vowel then moves one place forward: BEYOND → B D E N O Y → B D F N P Y. So PROMISE → E I M O P R S → F J M P P R S.

**Q.22 · Answer (D) HLQ**
In LPT, GKO and QUY each letter is 4 places after the one before it. HLQ moves +4 then +5, so it is the odd one.

**Q.23 · Answer (D) Certain**
'Equivocal', 'hesitant' and 'ambivalent' all describe uncertainty or indecision; 'certain' is their opposite.

**Q.24 · Answer (C) Fermentation**
An ohmmeter measures electrical resistance; a zymometer measures fermentation.

**Q.25 · Answer (B) ×, −, ÷, +**
With ×, −, ÷, +: 14 × 11 − 552 ÷ 23 + 29 = 154 − 24 + 29 = 159.

## General Awareness

**Q.1 · Answer (C) Umesh Sinha**
In December 2020 the government kept Umesh Sinha on as Deputy Election Commissioner until June 2021. Ashok Lavasa and Rajiv Kumar were Election Commissioners, members of the Commission itself.

**Q.2 · Answer (B) 1897**
Swami Vivekananda founded the Ramakrishna Mission in Calcutta on 1 May 1897.

**Q.3 · Answer (C) .tmp**
Temporary files usually carry the extension '.tmp'; '.txt' marks a plain text file and '.tar' an archive.

**Q.4 · Answer (A) golf**
In golf a birdie is one stroke under par on a hole, an eagle two under and an albatross three under.

**Q.5 · Answer (C) MS Dhoni**
MS Dhoni captained India in 60 Tests, the Indian record as of December 2020.

**Q.6 · Answer (B) Saturn**
Saturn had the most known moons: with 20 more announced in October 2019 its count reached 82, against Jupiter's 79.

**Q.7 · Answer (C) Thai Poosam**
Thaipusam, held in the Tamil month of Thai, honours Lord Murugan (Muruga). Pongal is a harvest festival, Aadi Perukku honours the rivers and Onam is Kerala's festival.

**Q.8 · Answer (D) women**
Security Council Resolution 2538, adopted on 28 August 2020 with India among its co-sponsors, is on women in peacekeeping, both uniformed and civilian.

**Q.9 · Answer (B) 1917**
Gandhi led the Champaran Satyagraha for the indigo farmers of Bihar in 1917, his first satyagraha in India.

**Q.10 · Answer (A) 3**
In December 2020 the Union Cabinet approved opening Indian Missions in three countries in 2021: Estonia, Paraguay and the Dominican Republic.

**Q.11 · Answer (D) Antimicrobial Resistance**
AMR stands for antimicrobial resistance: microbes stop responding to the medicines meant to kill them.

**Q.13 · Answer (D) Red laterite soil**
NCERT notes that the red laterite soils of Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh and Kerala suit crops like cashew nuts.

**Q.14 · Answer (A) Hima Kohli**
Justice Hima Kohli became Chief Justice of the Telangana High Court in January 2021, the first woman to hold the post.

**Q.15 · Answer (A) languages**
The Hakki Pikki and the Siddi are tribal communities of Karnataka; the People's Linguistic Survey of India listed their languages (the Hakki Pikki speak Vaagri) as critically endangered.

**Q.16 · Answer (B) Mahatma Gandhi**
'Pathway to God' gathers extracts from Mahatma Gandhi's writings and speeches on God, truth and prayer.

**Q.17 · Answer (C) KIRAN**
KIRAN, a toll-free mental health rehabilitation helpline, was launched by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment in September 2020.

**Q.18 · Answer (A) Central Bank of India**
Central Bank of India launched the contactless 'RuPay Select' debit card with NPCI on its 110th Foundation Day, 21 December 2020.

**Q.19 · Answer (C) Lonar**
Lonar Lake in Buldhana district, a crater lake formed by a meteorite impact, was declared a Ramsar site in November 2020.

**Q.20 · Answer (C) Serchhip**
Census 2011 put Serchhip in Mizoram at the top, with a literacy rate of about 97.9%.

**Q.21 · Answer (A) R Kaushik**
The cricket writer R Kaushik wrote the book, published in 2020 with a foreword by Ravi Shastri; it follows India's tours of Australia up to the first series win there, in 2018-19.

**Q.22 · Answer (A) Uttar Pradesh**
India Tourism Statistics 2020 put Uttar Pradesh first for domestic tourist visits in 2019, with about 536 million, ahead of Tamil Nadu.

**Q.23 · Answer (C) Narendra Singh Tomar**
Narendra Singh Tomar held Rural Development, with Agriculture and Panchayati Raj, from 2019 until the reshuffle of July 2021.

**Q.24 · Answer (D) Lactose**
Lactose, a sugar made of glucose and galactose, is the sugar found in milk.

**Q.25 · Answer (D) Ayodhya**
Ayodhya, in Uttar Pradesh, stands on the bank of the Saryu (Sarayu).

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